MARTA AXPE

Innovation and Experience Strategy Lead

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SUMMARY

Innovation and experience strategy leader with 12 years of experience bridging experimentation-led innovation, discovery, facilitation, and cross-functional collaboration across digital, physical, and service ecosystems, with a focus on sustainability-driven and consumer-facing industries.

EXPERIENCE

Innovation and Experience Strategy Consultant - Freelance 07/2025 – Present

Advised clients on innovation and product strategy to shape new opportunities and concepts.

- Unspoken: Deep dive discovery for YouTube to holistically understand both end-users and internal support teams. Leading qualitative research execution, synthesis, and insight generation. Acting as quality anchor to ensure coherence, depth, and strategic resonance across deliverables.
- lign.ai: Defined product strategy and experimentation roadmap for an AI-first platform focused on employability. Designed the MVP of the talent app and led testing of conversational agents to power coaching programs for enterprise clients.

Global Head of Innovation - Culligan International 10/2022 – 06/2025

Owned early-stage product innovation for a global drinking water solutions company.

- Led cross-functional discovery and experimentation using user research and piloting methods to identify new business and service opportunities, building an innovation pipeline of 16+ proof-of-concepts and 6 pilots, informed by 100+ end-user and customer interviews.
- Established and governed experiments across physical, digital, and service layers, defining hypotheses, success criteria, and learning goals to assess user desirability and commercial viability, reducing execution risk before market commitment.
- Drove the flavoured-water propositions and roadmap, from early opportunity identification to implementation, resulting in a new product category. Supported the business units' launches in the US and EU markets, with a projected revenue of $2.5M in 2025.
- Enabled transition from pilots to scale by partnering with regional business units through structured handovers, improving adoption readiness and scalability.
- Led and coached a cross-functional innovation team (~15 FTE) of internal employees and external partners across design and engineering, establishing clear team structures, rituals, and coaching practices with a strong focus on team health, individual development, and role clarity; supporting internal mobility and promotions, and strengthening collaboration between the team and business stakeholders.
- Championed a shift toward user-centric, design-led product development by onboarding and managing best-in-class design partners and actively educating internal teams on design processes, user focus, and expected deliverables.

Advanced Development Team Lead - Culligan International 11/2020 – 09/2022
Owned early-stage discovery and experimentation for digital and IoT-enabled water solutions.

- Owned discovery and validation for IoT-enabled propositions using research and prototyping practices, to test hypotheses, shortening feedback loops and reducing uncertainty.
- Collaborated closely with engineering, UX, product management and external vendors through Agile delivery rituals, to align user needs with technical implementation, improving feasibility and delivery predictability.
- Translated research insights into requirements and decision criteria, to guide development priorities, enabling more focused execution.

Strategic Design Lead - WEAREREASONABLEPEOPLE 11/2017 – 10/2020
Built and led service design and UX research capabilities within a design and technology agency.

- Established the UX Research and Service Design practice, defining methods, roles, and engagement models to expand the agency's strategic offering and get earlier-stage client work.
- Led end-to-end discovery for complex digital and service ecosystems, combining qualitative research, journey mapping, and service blueprinting to define experience visions (Vueling), inform digital roadmaps (Ampelmann), and coach early-stage incubation projects (Philips).
- Led monetization experimentation for ABN AMRO to identify sustainable revenue streams, running 10 user- and B2B-tested experiments that validated 4 monetization models and resulted in a feature shipped to production.
- Contributed to business development by shaping proposals, scopes, and use cases, reframing client challenges into design-led engagements with clear outcomes and investment rationale.
- Managed and coached service designers and researchers, establishing clear roles, maturity models and feedback loops to ensure delivery quality, autonomy and team development.

Consultant & Project Lead - INSITUM (now Accenture Song) 10/2014 – 10/2017
Led multi-country user research and innovation projects for global clients across industries.

- Conducted ethnographic and qualitative research across Big Tech, FMCG, healthcare, and public sector, translating insights into product and experience strategy.
- Oversaw a 12-month, multi-country continuous research program for Google's Help Center UX, informing localisation quality and iterative improvements to global experiences.
- Led qualitative end-user exploration for Clorox's Poett in LATAM to support the launch of a new fragrance, translating consumer insights into product direction that resulted in a market launch.

Research Assistant - Design for Sustainability (Delft University of Technology) 07/2012–09/2014

- Supported Product-Service Systems research and education through mentoring, coordination, and applied research on sustainable design, translating regional and European-commissioned work into applied insights.
- Explored behavior-change interventions through applied innovation research, designing and validating concepts to increase tap water consumption in a real-world public context.

SKILLS

Innovation Strategy & Management, Product Discovery & MVP Delivery, Product, Service & Experience Strategy, Human-Centered Design & UX Research, Lean Experimentation, Prototyping, Pilots & Validation, AI-Enabled Product Strategy, IoT & Connected Digital Ecosystems, Sustainable Product Development, Strategic Stakeholder Facilitation, Cross-Functional Collaboration

PLATFORM & TOOLS EXPERTISE

User Research: Dovetail, Condens, Maze, UserTesting | **Design and Prototyping:** Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Sketch | **Journey Mapping:** Miro, TheyDo | **Workflow and Collaboration:** Miro, Jira, Monday.com, Notion | **AI Prototyping:** Lovable, Stitch, Zapier | **AI Research Support:** Claude, NotebookLM | **Office & Productivity:** Google Workspace, Microsoft 365

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MSc in Strategic Product Design - Delft University of Technology 2013
BA in Product Design - EINA - Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona 2011

Agents course - Huggingface.co ongoing
Data Analytics Professional Certificate - DeepLearning.AI 2026
Prototyping with AI - IDEO U 2026

LANGUAGES

English - Proficient, **French** - Proficient, **Spanish** - Native, **Dutch** - Basic (Improving)

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Brand Strategy Speaker - Basque Culinary Center 2026
Delivered a brand-building workshop for food entrepreneurs
Service Design Coach 2024
Supported and guided young professionals entering the field.
Facebook Community Leadership Program 2019
Guest as human-centered design expert to support Community Leaders.
The Future of People Conference MIT 2016
Member of the organizational committee and foresight workshop facilitator.

REFERENCES

Available upon request